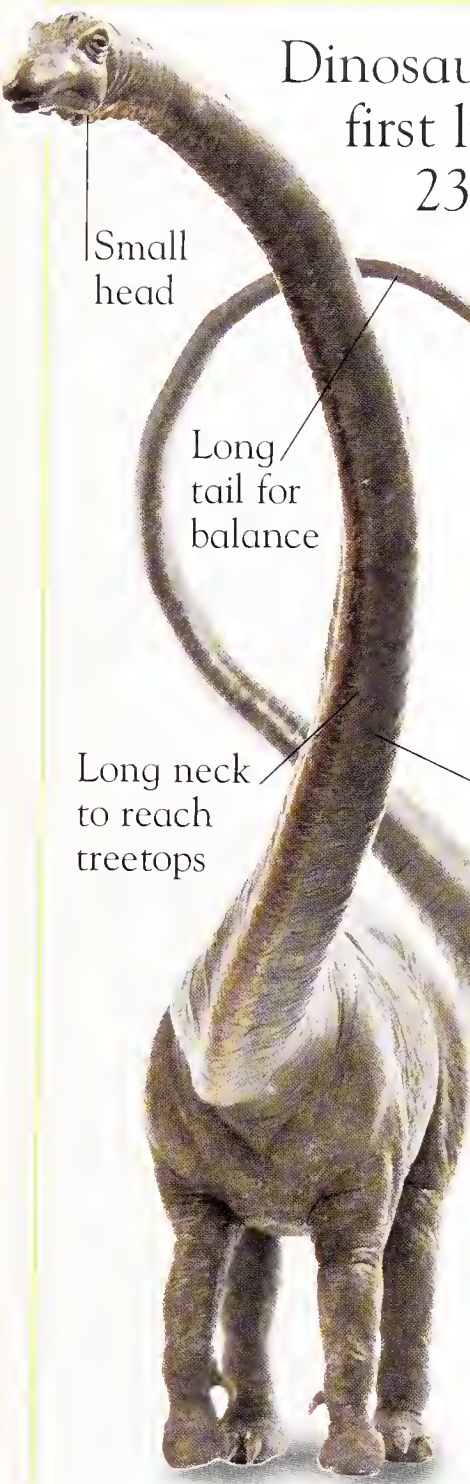




Dinosaurs



Small head

Long tail for balance

Long neck to reach treetops

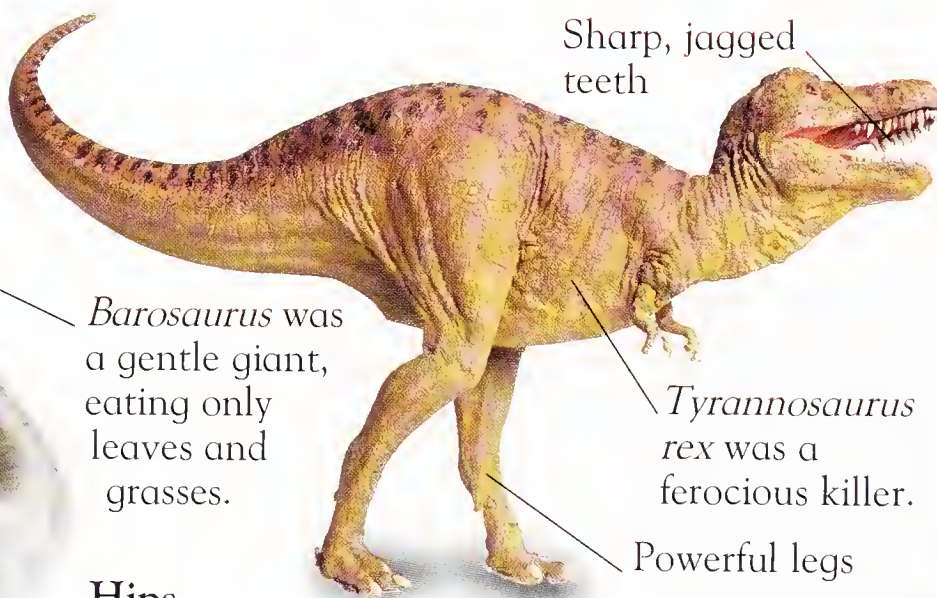
Dinosaurs were reptiles that first lived on Earth about 230 million years ago.

Meat eaters and plant eaters

Dinosaurs were either fierce hunters or gentle vegetarians.

Did you know?

One of the smallest dinosaurs was *Wannanosaurus*. It was the size of a chicken!



Sharp, jagged teeth

Barosaurus was a gentle giant, eating only leaves and grasses.

Tyrannosaurus rex was a ferocious killer.

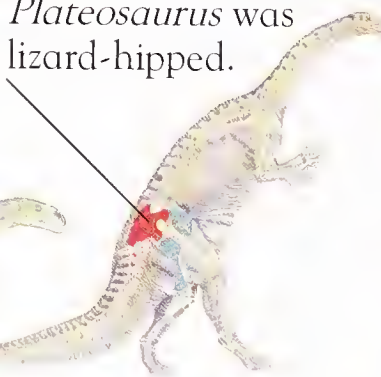
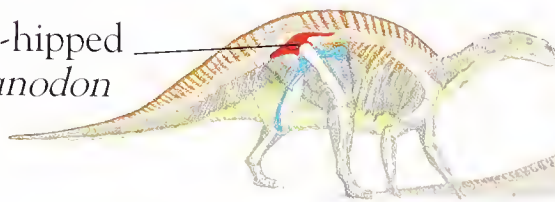
Powerful legs

Hips

Dinosaurs are divided into two groups, bird-hipped or lizard-hipped, depending on the shape of their hips.

Plateosaurus was lizard-hipped.

Bird-hipped *Iguanodon*



Changing Earth

The dinosaur age lasted so long that scientists have split it into three parts.



Dinosaurs first appeared 245 million years ago in the **Triassic period**.



In the **Jurassic period**, 208 million years ago, many new dinosaurs appeared.



Dinosaurs died out 65 million years ago at the end of the **Cretaceous period**.

Fossils

Scientists learn about dinosaurs by studying fossils found in the ground.

Model of dinosaur nest



Fossilized bones tell us the shape of these extinct animals.

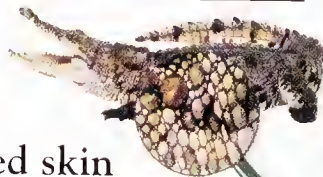


Struthiomimus



Fossilized egg

Crocodile



Fossilized skin shows that some dinosaurs were covered in scales like reptiles of today, such as crocodiles.

